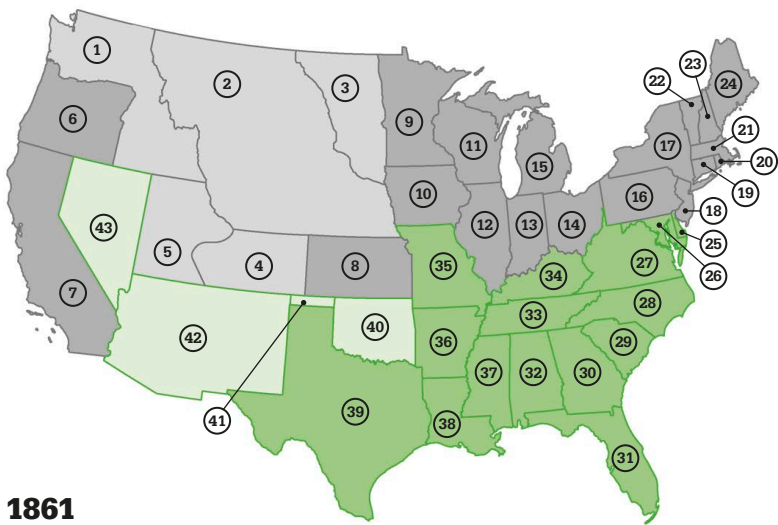




1861

- Slave states
- Slave territories*
- Free states
- Free territories*

Key:

- 1. Washington Territory
- 2. Nebraska Territory
- 3. Dakota Territory
- 4. Colorado
- 5. Utah
- 6. Oregon
- 7. California
- 8. Kansas
- 9. Minnesota
- 10. Iowa
- 11. Wisconsin
- 12. Illinois
- 13. Indiana
- 14. Ohio
- 15. Michigan
- 16. Pennsylvania
- 17. New York
- 18. New Jersey
- 19. Connecticut
- 20. Rhode Island
- 21. Massachusetts
- 22. Vermont
- 23. New Hampshire
- 24. Maine
- 25. Delaware
- 26. Maryland
- 27. Virginia
- 28. North Carolina
- 29. South Carolina
- 30. Georgia
- 31. Florida
- 32. Alabama
- 33. Tennessee
- 34. Kentucky
- 35. Missouri
- 36. Arkansas
- 37. Mississippi
- 38. Louisiana
- 39. Texas
- 40. Indian Territory
- 41. Neutral strip
- 42. New Mexico
- 43. Nevada Territory

* Territory: region directly ruled by federal government

Slave states numbered 15 in 1861 at the start of the Civil War, up from 8 in 1789, but were now outnumbered by 19 Free states. At the war's end, slavery was banned in all US states and territories.

	1789	1800	1821	1837	1846	1858	1861
Slave states	8	9	12	13	15	15	15
Free states	5	8	12	13	14	17	19

President Abraham Lincoln's advocacy of abolition strengthened the more the Southern Confederacy threatened the Union (Northern States of America). In 1863, his Emancipation Proclamation declared free all slaves in rebellious states. It did not apply to slave states loyal to the Union, but did allow black men to enlist. After the Union's victory, the Thirteenth Amendment was ratified in 1865, abolishing slavery across the US and setting more than 4 million slaves free.

Limited rights

After the Civil War, President Andrew Johnson was eager to allow Southern states to set their own laws, provided that they recognized the Thirteenth Amendment and repaid their war debts. When the Southern states began passing

laws, called "black codes," that restricted the rights of freed slaves, many in the North were outraged.

In 1866, Congress passed the Civil Rights Act: anyone born in the United States had the right to citizenship and equality before the law. Congress then took control of reconstruction in the South and took care to enforce the Fourteenth Amendment, which granted equal protections under the Constitution to former slaves. In 1870, Congress adopted the Fifteenth Amendment, which guaranteed that a citizen's right to vote could not be denied "on account of race, color, or previous condition of servitude."

Although slavery was officially abolished, in the Deep South, a practice called "peonage" persisted into the 1920s. African Americans who had been convicted (often on

false charges) were sent to work in dangerous workplaces, such as brick factories, plantations, and mines, to "pay off" their fines. This trapped workers in a cycle of unpaid work and mounting debt. The 1964 Civil Rights Act banned racial segregation and employment discrimination, which had been used in the South to stop black people exercising their freedoms.

Slavery today

Debt slavery continues in the 21st century. Britain passed the Modern Slavery Act in 2015 to outlaw such practices as compelling migrant workers to work to pay off human traffickers. However, despite a raft of similar legislation, vulnerable people continue to be exploited across the world, with up to 45 million people effectively enslaved. ■